Hosla & Shraddha
Attendance, Engagement & Participation Tracker

Business Need, Ideation & Proposed Solution

How the workbook tabs fit together

- **01 Product Overview** — What the product is, who uses it, and the main goals.
- **02 Data Model** — What information the system needs to store: members, activities, attendance, participation, points and messages.
- **03 Admin Attendance** — How the coordinator records attendance during an activity.
- **04 Member Dashboard** — What an individual member can see about their own attendance, streaks and participation.
- **05 Active Role Allocation** — Rules for deciding who should get active roles such as singer, reader or speaker.
- **06 Allocation View** — The practical weekly view where suggested members and coordinator decisions are shown.
- **07 Reports** — Admin and member-level summaries for attendance, absence, streaks and participation.
- **08 Message Rules** — When the system should trigger supportive messages for absence, milestones or contribution.
- **09 MVP Backlog** — The features that should actually be built, separated by MVP and later phases.
- **10 Developer Notes** — Technical rules and implementation guidance so the product behaves safely and consistently.

PART 1 — NEEDS: BUSINESS PROBLEM & IDEATION

The core need is not simply to record attendance. The system should help Hosla & Shraddha understand participation, notice prolonged absence, encourage continued engagement, and distribute active opportunities fairly—without turning senior-citizen participation into a competitive or punitive system.

1. **Attendance is difficult to track consistently** — Attendance needs to be recorded for different activities and sessions in a structured way instead of relying on scattered or manual records.
2. **Absence needs attention, not just a mark** — A simple Present/Absent record does not tell coordinators when someone has been away for several sessions and may need a friendly check-in.
3. **Regular participation should be visible** — The organisation needs a simple way to recognise consistency through attendance history, streaks and milestones.
4. **Active participation is different from attendance** — Someone may attend by listening or watching, while another person may actively sing, read, speak or lead. These are related but should be recorded separately.
5. **Active roles need fair distribution** — When activities need singers, readers, speakers or other roles, coordinators need a repeatable way to avoid repeatedly selecting the same people.
6. **Coordinators need less manual decision-making** — The system should surface useful information—recent participation, skills and role history—so coordinators do not have to check multiple records before assigning a role.
7. **Members need visibility into their own journey** — Members should be able to see their attendance, activities attended, roles performed and milestones without needing to ask an administrator.
8. **Communication should be timely and respectful** — Absence-related messages should be supportive rather than guilt-driven, with consent and frequency limits so members are not repeatedly contacted.

9. **Management needs useful summaries** — The organisation needs reports that show attendance trends, prolonged absence, activity engagement and participation distribution over time.
10. **The system must remain simple and safe to operate** — The solution should work well during live sessions, handle weak connectivity, preserve an audit trail, protect member privacy and avoid treating Excel as the production database.

PART 2 — SOLUTION: WHAT THE TABS TOGETHER ARE PROPOSING

The tabs describe one connected system. Attendance is the foundation; participation, allocation, member visibility, reports and messaging are built around it. The following 10 points combine the functional ideas from all tabs into one understandable solution.

11. **Create a central member and activity record** — Maintain unique member profiles and activity/session records, including member status, skills, consent, activity date/time and activity type.
12. **Provide a fast admin attendance screen** — For each activity, the coordinator opens the roster, searches members and marks Present with one tap. Bulk actions such as Present All and marking remaining members Absent make large sessions faster.
13. **Keep attendance statuses clear and auditable** — Use Present, Absent, Excused and Unmarked. Attendance edits record who changed the record and when, and Unmarked should not silently become Absent.
14. **Separate attendance from active participation** — Attendance answers "Did the member attend?" while participation answers "What active role did the member perform?" This keeps the data clear while allowing the two to work together.
15. **Give every member a personal dashboard** — Members can view their current streak, milestones, attendance calendar/history, activity history, active roles and—if enabled—points or badges.
16. **Calculate meaningful streaks and milestones** — The system can recognise milestones such as 7-day, 14-day or longer streaks, with the exact streak definition configurable according to scheduled Self Care sessions or calendar days.
17. **Suggest fair active-role assignments** — For each role, the system checks eligibility, skills, recent role count, last role date and rotation rules, then presents eligible candidates to the coordinator. The coordinator remains able to override the suggestion.
18. **Provide an allocation and reporting layer** — A weekly allocation view shows the activity, role, suggested member, eligible members, recent counts and last role date. Reports then summarise attendance, long absence, streaks, activity engagement and participation distribution.
19. **Use controlled, supportive messaging** — The system can flag members after defined absence thresholds and trigger approved messages, while respecting communication consent, frequency limits, delivery status and escalation rules.
20. **Build the MVP in phases on a proper database** — The initial product should prioritise activity setup, attendance, audit, member history, streaks, absence watchlist and active-role history. Fair allocation, messaging and live attendance follow, while points/badges and advanced analytics can be added later. Production data should live in relational tables/API rather than Excel.

Simple mental model

Think of the entire workbook as one flow:

Members → Activities → Attendance → Participation → Fair Allocation → Dashboard & Reports → Supportive Messages

In short: first record who attended, then record what they contributed, use that history to distribute future opportunities fairly, and finally use the accumulated data to support members and help coordinators.

Recommended interpretation of the tabs

The tabs are therefore not ten separate products or ten versions of the same feature. They are ten views of one product specification, each answering a different question:

- **What are we building and why? —**
- **What data must the system store? —**
- **How does an admin record attendance? —**
- **What does a member see? —**
- **How should active roles be distributed? —**
- **Where does the coordinator review those suggestions? —**
- **What should the organisation measure? —**
- **When should communication happen? —**
- **What should be built first? —**
- **What technical rules must developers follow? —**

Bottom line: The product is best understood as an attendance system with an engagement and participation layer—not just an attendance register. Attendance provides the base data; participation history enables fair role allocation; dashboards and reports make the information useful; and messaging turns important signals such as prolonged absence into appropriate follow-up.